

TIMELINE

- **July 13, 1821** Born in Chapel Hill, Tennessee, eldest son of William and Miriam Forrest. Grows up in Tennessee and Mississippi.
- **September 25, 1845** Marries Mary Ann Montgomery in Hernando, Mississippi.
- **June 1858** Having become a wealthy trader of enslaved people, in Memphis, he is elected a city alderman.
- **June 1861** Enlists as a private in Company E, Tennessee Mounted Rifles. Soon after, he is approached about raising his own battalion of cavalry. In October, he is appointed lieutenant colonel of Forrest's Tennessee Cavalry Battalion.
- **February 1862** With his command, Forrest cuts his way out of besieged Fort Donelson just before its garrison surrenders.
- **April 6-8, 1862** Commands the Confederate rearguard at the Battle of Shiloh; wounded in the spine at Fallen Timbers.
- **July 13, 1862** Promoted to brigadier general after capturing Stones River (Murfreesboro), Tennessee, and its vast depots of supplies.
- **April-May 1863** Wins the running series of engagements in Mississippi and Alabama known as "Streight's Raid," ultimately surrounding and capturing the remaining Union cavalymen.
- **September 20, 1863** Captures hundreds of fleeing Union troops after Battle of Chickamauga.
- **December 4, 1863** Promoted to major general.
- **February 22, 1864** Wins the Battle of Okolona, Mississippi, defeating General William Sooy Smith, driving the Union forces over 11 miles (18km) until stopped by lack of ammunition.
- **April 12, 1864** Attacks and demands surrender of Fort Pillow on the Mississippi River; two-thirds of the garrison are killed, many of the Black troops after surrendering.
- **June 10, 1864** Routs General Samuel Sturgis's 8,100 soldiers at the Battle of Brice's Crossroads.
- **August 21, 1864** Raids downtown Memphis, despite its being garrisoned by 6,000 troops.
- **October 3, 1864** Raids the Union supply depot at Johnsonville, Tennessee.
- **December 18, 1864** Begins covering the retreat of Hood's shattered Army of Tennessee after its defeat in the Battle of Nashville.